

Donald Fanning

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Summary:

As a professional with experience in project **management**, **systems engineering**, and operations within an enterprise organization, I am highly skilled and motivated. I am open to various job roles, including Contract, Contract-to-Hire, and Direct Hire. I am now seeking a challenging role that can utilize my expertise in **DevOps** methodology and practices, **cloud/systems architecture**, **infrastructure** as code, **implementation**, and operations.

Experience:

Sabbatical Leave

July 2021-present

After the bereavement of the relationship with my wife of 25 years, I ended up taking personal time to reflect and reconsider plans and decisions for the future of my life. By the time I felt ready to reenter the workforce, there was an industry wide slowdown in hiring and I have been pursuing employment ever since.

During this time, I have been filling it with college level study of non-technical related topics such as psychology, economics, sociology to better understand human **systems** and to better understand people and our perceptions of one another. I feel these topics will help any eventual move down a **management** path, but I also continue to pursue technical skill acquisition and maintenance such as my latest goal as of December 2024 to become certified in **Microsoft Azure Solutions Architecture**.

Disney – Total 7 years (2 as a Contractor and 5 as an FTE Cast Member)

Sr. Site Reliability Engineer – Disney Direct To Consumer and Interactive (DTCI)

January 2019 – September 2020 (1 year 9 months) (Laid Off)

I was part of the Guest and Data Services team who are responsible for all consumer-facing user data utilized by Disney for their seamless "Disney ID" offering. This group was tasked with servicing, maintaining, and protecting the data while providing a high level of service availability. During this time, we migrated Disney's OAuth2 product into AWS **Cloud** Hosting and validated the **security** of the platform once migrated. My role with this team culminated at its peak with the launch of Disney+ for North America in November of 2019.

In the latter part of my tenure, I assumed a role with the Messaging team to prepare for another NCAA season when it was announced that the product was being discontinued and dismantled. My role was to maintain the service levels for ABC News (Elections) and ESPN while educating the ESPN engineers for this conclusion.

During my tenure with DTCL, I was mainly using AWS CloudFormation with one product and GitLab CI/CD with **Terraform** for another product. I also utilized AWS SDK (NodeJS and **Python**) to build data pipelines for stream processing as well as care and feeding of deployments and changes. My last projects prior to layoff were in the realm of Chaos **Engineering** and building step functions and circuit breakers to provide alternative paths of **workflow** if one is not available along with creating a **virtual networking** testbed to simulate **network** failure to better identify and work with developers in creating resilient **software**.

Sr. Systems Engineer / Sr. Site Reliability Engineer – The Walt Disney Company (Corporate)

May 2015 - January 2019 (3 years 9 months) (Reorganization)

After my FTE conversion at Disney, I continued with DTSS with the same "Platform Services" group practicing **DevOps** methodology for SSO, Messaging and APIM core technologies on a production basis. My specialization evolved into an Observation and **Monitoring** SME role, using tools like NewRelic, DataDog, and Thousand Eyes, and self-hosted instances of Prometheus and Grafana on InfluxDB. During my tenure on this team, I supported existing products and performed **systems engineering** on various other new projects. Such as, I consulted, constructed and operated "AvengerNET" for a product entitled "Playmation". I also was the SRE assigned to an early Machine Learning accelerator project. This experience broadened my skillset and expertise in innovative technologies while continuing to support core products that are critical to the company.

I continued to develop/support **scripting** and **automation** built to gather data and develop an overall picture of our application observability. For this, I used languages such as **Python** and Ruby with some occasional Perl, GoLang and RLang depending on task. Some **systems** were based on StatsD/Datadog agents going to either SaaS or self-hosted metric databases such as Riemann, Prometheus, InfluxDB, Graphite/Grafana. While I still had a ticket queue to manage

and guided junior engineers with mentoring, I was still called upon to be part of the 24/7 on-call rotation troubleshooting issues that were varied. Cases such as:

- Since most all our instances were related to being in the data path of various operations and we were in the data path for all of them, we needed to build observability and tools to not only see what is coming into us, but where it is going. We already had logging that would track transactional data with conversations where possible, but my role was to build dashboarding where possible that would document and illustrate this story. To do this I used NRQL as well as importing data from other sources using Ruby or Python into a common time-series platform (in our case New Relic) that would allow for sophisticated queries across datasets and easier dashboard creation.
- There are times being a legacy messaging team that we would get esoteric requests as we were the main email gateway for applications in and out of Disney that wasn't hosted by Exchange. Sometimes these requests would be from ticket reservations or even from HR. With a company as big as Disney, my job is to help my fellow employees (Cast Members) to succeed in their efforts, not just toss it over the fence. I have the tools and resources to identify ownership of systems and products, thus I became a conduit for them to succeed. Obviously, this also requires deep insight into email delivery technologies including DKIM/SPF/DNS and other technologies.
- I have a Cisco Certified Network Professional certification that I vaguely used at OnAir. In a corporation such as Disney, either you are a network engineer, or you are not. But with my applications being central to everything, having global network knowledge helps. There was an outage call and of course I looked at my systems and everything was fine. But using tools like ThousandEyes which set up thousands of sensors both on the internet and internal, I was able to see asymmetrical routing issues inside our internal network coming from overseas and bringing that into the outage call made people's lives much easier that day.
- In addition, I have worked on various projects. Some of it related to Blockchain like Disney DragonChain in which I was the SRE assigned to the project where we used Azure to build out our application. Same with AvengerNET which was a toy sold to kids that had an online component (an API with an CMS attached to it). My job is to build IaC scripting to deliver these applications – for on-premises we used Chef and Ruby. But for other tasks, we would begin to use Mono/C#, Python or other languages.
- During this time, we were doing our cloud migration from VMWare to AWS. I used Ruby, Python and BASH scripting to manipulate some deployments, or would roll it in further into Terraform and GitLab CI/CD to build out a complete automated build platform.
- Machine Learning during this time was limited to commercial offerings but was also seeing that data sanitation would become a big issue going forward and hence my observability efforts also reflected this awareness.

Systems Engineer - Contractor with The Walt Disney Company (DTSS)

August 2013 - May 2015 (1 year 10 months) (Contractor to FTE Conversion)

At Walt Disney Company, DTSS is an internal software development and support group dedicated to improving the Disney experience for their target consumer. I worked as a member of the Disney Platform Services team, supporting various products, including APIM, OAuth2, Mass Messaging, and Sign-In systems used by Disney properties like ABC, ESPN, Marvel, Pixar, and others. Our team used Chef with the Ruby scripting language, VMWare, OpenStack, F5, HPE SiteScope, Java, Linux, and Windows scripting to ensure seamless interoperability between systems and networks. As a senior engineer, I worked across all three product spaces during my seven-year tenure. DTSS was established after Disney's acquisition of "go.com" in 1999, which expedited their acquisition of internet technology. In addition, I worked tickets from network outages to email delivery issues, to application failures within the products I supported. We had complete SE ownership of the product and worked a on-call rotation 24/7. Since Ruby was our primary language for the IaC (Chef), many other scripts were written not only the cookbooks and test-driven development but also to create shim scripting to feed metrics from say the application into New Relic or Datadog. I built scripting to automate our patch automation to coordinate load balancer membership (we used F5 LTM) and test systems prior to taking production traffic after a software release. All systems ran RHEL at this point on VMWare ESXi.

Consultant - Self**January 1996 – August 2013 (17 years 8 months) (Closed Business)**

As a Concierge Consultant for various C-Suite Executives within the Fortune 500 space, I provide personal technology and InfoSec support. My experience includes Cloud and InfoSec tasks, Network/Infrastructure architecture, Systems Engineering, and implementation and operations.

Sr. Systems Administrator – OnAir (an Airbus/SITA joint venture)**May 2008 - May 2013 (5 years 1 month) (Laid Off)**

I was a Sr. Systems Administrator at OnAir, a mobile network provider for in-flight communication services. OnAir enables passengers to use their portable devices for calls, messaging, and Internet browsing while in-flight. I played a key role in ensuring the smooth operation of the company's main product, which provides GSM and WiFi services onboard airplanes worldwide. OnAir was the first company to provide integrated GSM and inflight Wi-Fi services as well as being the lineage of Tenzing which offered internet on Boeing aircraft since the late 1990s. My role there included Linux and Solaris systems support, building and scripting GSM test benches using Android devices and test harness to over 50 mobile devices with different sim cards to simulate calling in and out of the network. This also included working with Asterisk PBX to provide the endpoint calling and receiving test calls. In addition, there was additional scripting work not only with patch automation but flight tracking of hardware, remote state of the online service (read only as per FAA regulations) and others. Scripting languages were Perl, Python and BASH to complete these tasks.

Sr. Systems Administrator - Cypheredge**November 2007 - February 2008 (4 months) (Laid Off – Economic Downturn)**

I was a Sr. Systems Administrator for CypherEdge, a Bellevue-based Software Development Company. CypherEdge offers patented technologies for wireless proximity and customer experience marketing communications. Their real-time interaction builds brand equity, loyalty, and revenue by allowing customers to manage relevant and timely messages from their preferred brands. My role there was to maintain company operations as well as support development efforts thus primarily building Websphere, Oracle and other tech stacks while learning how they utilized Bluetooth to send JIT marketing data with ultra-precise geolocation within structures. Company was dissolved with the 2008 financial crash. CypherEdge used both Linux and Solaris systems with Websphere to develop their products.

Unix Systems Administrator – Bonneville Power Administration (Department of Energy – US Gov)**February 2006 - June 2006 (5 months) (Contract Ended)**

I was a Unix Systems Administrator at the U.S. Department of Energy for five months. Oversaw the maintenance of 150 BPA-owned servers based on Sun, Digital, and HP architectures running various variants of the Linux/UNIX operating system. I focused on creating Sendmail-milter rules for SPAM filtering and maintaining servers dedicated to NCAR ingestion for weather data. Additionally, I provided support for "legacy" systems that were not based on LAMP or IIS/SQL. There was additional work with script automation using BASH to train HAM/SPAM filtering in addition to patch management. There was a support queue that I did work through over the various issues relating to Linux/Unix systems including terminal servers, email and other systems tasks.

Operations Analyst/Data Center Engineer - Microsoft**November 2001 - April 2004 (2 years 6 months) (Reorganization)**

As an Engineer for MSN Infrastructure Platform Services, I collaborated with my peers to maintain 24/7 operations for internet-facing enterprises like MSN, Expedia, Xbox, and Microsoft along with MSNBC. My primary role was to be "smart hands" for MS Engineers within the company, but I worked to improve my skills in the datacenter spaces by writing tools and software solutions using VBS/C# as well as trial evaluated with developers work method improvements using TabletPC. Additionally, I played a significant role in specing, building and operating several Storage Area Networks for MSN bCentral, Microsoft, and Xbox Live products during the original releases with shipping awards for doing so. Site Services first used SIEBEL ticketing system as it was the same for Corp IT but then with the MSN take over of Canyon Park, we began dogfooding and building tools for MSN Asset and other ticketing tools.

IT Systems Technician – TAC Worldwide Services for Siemens and Microsoft February 2001 - September 2001 (8 months) (Contract Ended)

I performed server hardware migrations between enterprise hosting data centers for Siemens Business Services to Microsoft Corporation through TAC Worldwide, for cost and logistical reasons before the cloud era. Occasionally, I worked on contracts with USPS installing "Dinero Seguro" wire transfer terminals in post offices across the Puget sound region. After 9/11, the job market was challenging, but my prior experience and networking connections helped me secure an interview for Microsoft's first fully employed data center engineering team in the Seattle area.

Project and Office Manager – Zimco Construction October 1998 - December 2000 (2 years 3 months) (Laid Off)

As a Project Manager, IT Admin, and CAD Draftsman, I worked for a small-mid General Contractor specializing in highly energy-efficient semi-custom home building projects in Soldotna, Alaska. Our projects consistently achieved an average of over 93% EF based on blower door envelope tests.

Education

University of Alaska Anchorage - Baccalaureate of Science - Computer Sciences

Current Academic Identifier – ORCID 0000-0003-3326-5112

Licenses & Certifications

- Cisco (CCNA/CCNP) - Issued Mar 2010 - Expires May 2016 - CSC011470456
- Microsoft (MCP – MCSE Windows 2000 Track) – Several during 2002 – B434-3517 with Azure era MCID: 2709277

Skills

Unix • System Administration • Enterprise Architecture • Software Development • Shell Scripting • Computer Security • Systems Engineering • SAN • Penetration Testing • Cloud Computing • Virtualization and Containerization • Observability and Golden Signal Architecture • Chaos, Chat and AI Operations advocate and implementer within the Dev(Sec)Ops methodology realms

Don Fanning

- Seattle, WA, US

Contact Information

- o57-vd4-s7g@mail.dice.com

Work History

Total Work Experience: 29 years

- Sr. **Systems Engineer** / Sr. **Site Reliability Engineer**/Sr. The Walt Disney Company
Aug 01, 2013
- Sr. **Systems** Administrator Onair/SITA
May 01, 2008
- **Senior** Linux **Systems** Administrator - Contractor Bonneville Power Administration
/ Department Of Energy
Jan 01, 2005
- **Systems** Analyst/**Systems Engineer** **Microsoft**
Feb 01, 2001
- **Hacker SELF**
Feb 01, 1996

Education

- **Bachelors** | University of Alaska

Skills

- **cc++c#** - 30 years

- **cybersecurity** - 30 years
- **dns** - 30 years
- **electronics** - 30 years
- **engineering** - 30 years
- **cad** - 27 years
- **infrastructure architecture** - 25 years
- **active directory** - 23 years
- **agile** - 23 years
- **data center** - 23 years
- **documentation** - 23 years
- **enterprise architecture** - 23 years
- **observability** - 23 years
- **perl** - 23 years
- **systems engineering** - 23 years
- **aws** - 15 years
- **cisco** - 15 years
- **ccnp** - 13 years
- **gsm** - 13 years
- **chef** - 10 years
- **devops** - 10 years
- **ruby** - 10 years
- **sre** - 10 years
- **azure** - 7 years
- **python** - 5 years
- **bash**
- **c level executive support**
- **cisco systems products**
- **cloud computing**
- **computer security**
- **consulting**
- **databases**
- **disaster recovery**
- **docker products**
- **enterprise software**
- **firewalls**
- **information technology**
- **internet protocol suite**
- **java**
- **linux**
- **mobile devices**
- **network architecture**
- **network security**
- **networking**
- **operating systems**
- **penetration testing**

- polyglot
- powershell
- project management
- radio frequency engineering
- research
- routing
- san
- security
- servers
- shell scripting
- software development
- solaris
- storage area network
- storage area networks
- system administration
- system architecture
- system deployment
- systems architecture
- telecommunications
- test and development
- troubleshooting
- unix
- virtualization
- vmware
- windows server

Work Preferences

- Desired Work Settings: No Preference
- Likely to Switch: True
- Willing to Relocate: False
- Travel Preference: 50%
- Work Authorization:
 - US
- Work Documents:
 - US Citizen
- Security Clearance: False
- Desired Hourly Rate: 85+ (USD)
- Desired Salary: 175,000+ (USD)
- Third Party: False
- Employment Type:
 - Full-time

- Part-time
- Contract - Independent
- Contract - W2
- Contract to Hire - Independent
- Contract to Hire - W2

Profile Sources

- linkedin: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/donfanning>
- twitter: https://twitter.com/don_fanning
- Dice:
<https://www.dice.com/employer/talent/profile/63786a5c12f6c2d858ef8503c9bdd3e1>